

Probably primarily 'revelation from Jesus... he is the source.
but clearly also 'revelation of Jesus'... he is also the main subject.

Revelation 1:1-3 (RSV)

A prologue to the letter

The revelation of Jesus Christ,
which God gave him

to show to his servants

what must soon take place;

and he made

it known

by sending his angel

to his servant John,

who bore witness to the word of God

and to the testimony of Jesus Christ,

even to all that he saw.

Blessed is he who reads aloud

and blessed are those who hear,

and who keep

the words of the prophecy,

what is written therein;

for the time is near.

Focus is on the
recipients
but includes us!

A sense of imminence
→ eschatological urgency?
→ coming into view?

The first audience is the
primary audience!
(Not just 2nd C. Xns)

our job
description?

- 3-fold blessing
- requires a response (to 'keep' it)
 - > similar to 'keeping' Torah
 - > to keep, guard & observe
 - > faithful obedience
 - > protective watching

As a whole, the Revelation
calls us to -

- > grow in wisdom
- > faithful witness
- > lived out worship

John regards these as
equivalent ... he was aware
he was writing Scripture!?

? In our context ?

Resistance to
'empire'
(Koester)

⇒ Dissident
discipleship.
(McKnight)